

# Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Senate President Don Harmon presides over the newly renovated Senate chamber on Jan. 8 at the Illinois State Capitol in Springfield.  
BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

## A colorful addition

The Illinois Senate chamber is back in business under an ornate stained glass skylight as part of ongoing Capitol renovations

By Addison Wright  
Chicago Tribune

Using a pencil-size tool, Megan Smith spent countless hours cutting glass for a stained glass skylight destined for the ceiling of the Senate chamber in the Illinois State Capitol building.

Smith did the work in the evenings after working her day job at a state agency. She has dabbled in arts and crafts as hobbies but never worked on professional project of this kind.

"The very first time I ever went to break the glass I was so scared

and nervous, and was like: Should I be protecting my eyes? Like, what if it cracks and breaks in the wrong spot?" Smith said in a telephone interview. "And you know, I was getting a little sweaty, a little heated, but the more that I did it, the more confident I felt, the more it was muscle memory."

The \$350,000 skylight project is a small but striking part of a larger, ongoing \$350 million renovation of the Illinois State Capitol and its surrounding property that has been underway since 2021 and is slated to wrap up by the end of this year. The work has focused on

the building's north wing, which includes the third-floor Senate chamber.

The chamber was shuttered for about three years because of the makeover, forcing the state's 59 senators to temporarily convene in the Michael J. Howlett Building south of the statehouse. The newly renovated Senate space made its public debut on Jan. 8 when senators were sworn in by Gov. JB Pritzker during the first day of the General Assembly's new session.

Capitol Architect Andrea Aggert said the skylight, also known as a laylight, was an effort

to re-create an element of the chamber that has been missing for 90 years. An old black-and-white photo showed a similar element had once hovered above the chamber. It was discovered that the skylight was removed in the 1920s and replaced with a decorative plaster. Aggert helped overlay the black-and-white photo with colors common during the time period, and the laylight project was launched.

"We did a lot of research on what the building used to be, and

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## Courts a 'front line' against Trump

Legal actions seek to test the deluge of executive orders

By Mattathias Schwartz  
The New York Times

PHILADELPHIA — More than 40 lawsuits filed in recent days by state attorneys general, unions and nonprofits seek to erect a bulwark in the federal courts against President Donald Trump's blitzkrieg of executive actions that have upended much of the federal government and challenged the Constitution's checks and balances.

Unlike the opening of Trump's first term in 2017, little significant resistance to his second term has arisen in the streets, the halls of Congress or within his own Republican Party. For now at least, lawyers say, the judicial branch may be it.

"The courts really are the front line," said Skye Perryman, CEO of Democracy Forward, which has filed nine lawsuits and won four court orders against the Trump administration.

The multipronged legal pushback has already yielded quick — if potentially fleeting — results. Judicial orders in nine federal court cases will, for a time, partially bind the administration's hands on its goals. Those include ending automatic citizenship for babies born to immigrants living on U.S. soil without legal permission; transferring transgender female inmates to male-only

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"Just the thought that there could be a raid is upsetting," said L'Patron owner Cesar Gonzalez.  
E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

## Restaurant workers brace for ICE

Arrests casting fear, uncertainty over area's food service industry

By Zareen Syed and Talia Soglin  
Chicago Tribune

For the first time in her 15 years working in a Chicago restaurant, Malena knows what to do if immigration officials come knocking at her workplace.

Malena, who spoke on the condition that the Tribune not publish her last name or the restaurant where she works, is one of the Chicago-area restaurant workers living and working in the shadow of President

Donald Trump's immigration crackdown.

In an industry that relies heavily on the labor of immigrants, restaurant workers like Malena, their advocates and employers have spent the last few weeks educating themselves and each other on their immigration rights and preparing for what to do if confronted by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers.

According to the National Restaurant Association, 21% of restaurant workers and food service employees in the United States were born outside the country. That includes workers who have obtained legal status and those without. The Center

for Migration Studies, however, recently estimated that there are 1 million undocumented workers employed in restaurants.

So far, workplace raids at local restaurants have not materialized, although rumors of them have flourished at times. Sam Toia, the president of the Illinois Restaurant Association, said Friday that he was not aware of any ICE activity at Chicago restaurants.

But for some workers and restaurateurs, the anxiety of possible raids is hard to avoid.

Malena remembers the fear that came with Trump's first term. Eight years later, she said,

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### DUPAGE COUNTY

## Officials eye taking Hyde's name off court building

Proposal has board divided on party lines

By Bob Goldsborough  
Chicago Tribune

A proposal to strip the name of the late U.S. Rep. Henry Hyde from the DuPage County courthouse and related offices in Wheaton is up for a vote on the DuPage County Board's agenda for Tuesday, and the measure is dividing Republicans and Democrats.

Hyde, a Wood Dale Republican and a staunch abortion opponent

who chaired the U.S. House Judiciary Committee from 1995 until 2001, died in 2007. Three years later, the DuPage County Board voted to name its courthouse building, at 505 N. County Farm Road in Wheaton, the Henry J. Hyde Judicial Office Facility and allow for a privately funded statue of Hyde to be placed outside the building.

Now, with the DuPage County Board squarely in control by Democrats — a stark change from the past, when Republicans ruled

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### SUPER BOWL LIX



DOUG BENC/AP

## Battle in the bayou

The Kansas City Chiefs and the Philadelphia Eagles competed for the NFL championship Sunday in New Orleans. For complete coverage, go to your Monday eNewspaper for a four-page special section.

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 33 Low 21

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere  
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